high wall and a roof, but was not screened. Gertrude could, and did, make up a cot there, and on hot nights she would sleep there while I slept indoors.

5

The June 1951 Astounding arrived and had "Breeds There a Man?" 3 in it. I was very pleased. It had been exactly one year since I had last had a story in Astounding, and in that interval, I had had two shorts, a novelette, and a three-part serial in Galaxy. Six of the first eight issues of this new magazine had had something by me in it, and I felt like a traitor. With "Breeds There a Man?" I felt better, and I made up my mind to offer "The Currents of Space" to Campbell for serialization.

It was about now, too, that Life came out with an article on science fiction and ran the banquet photograph of the July 1950 convention at which Brad and Fred had lured me into drinking. I got a copy at work and there I was, far in the background and not very recognizable, but clearly drunk.

Gertrude sat next to me, much more nearly in focus, smiling and looking very pretty indeed, though unfortunately only half her face showed. I called her on the phone and said, "Gertrude, your picture is in Life magazine."

I expected disbelief but she just said, with mild puzzlement, "I didn't give them a picture." She didn't even ask why she was in.

On May 21, 1951, my raise finally came through, retroactive to April 1.1 would be paid now at the rate of $5,500.

It gave me no satisfaction at all. It was humiliating to have made such a fuss and to have had to go through conferences and pleadings and threats for so little. One good novelette could bring in more than the annual increase and I would have been thanked for it by the editor, praised for it by the readers, and paid additionally for it by anthologists.

Besides which, there was usually only a small plum in the department budget to divide (if any), and if I got $500 extra a year, someone else in the department, without my ability to make money on the side, might not get it. It seemed improper for me to scrabble for these small sums when I needed it less than the next guy.

3 See Nightfall and Other Stories.

As a result, I specifically denied any interest in pay increases from this time